

INTERPENETRATION OF THE DIVINE LIGHT SPARK INTO THE OUTER REGIONS

Greetings and blessings for all of you, my dearest, dearest friends. Particular blessings are given to the beginning of a new working year -- a particularly significant one. For this year sees the fruition of a spiritual form materializing into an earthly form. The building of this is indeed a beautiful venture with which you fulfill yourself because you fulfill your task in the universe. Whatever difficulties have to be overcome are an expression of the sum total of the "body" that all of you form. This group, as well as all other created entities, has its own spiritual body. A body consisting of many aspects just as the individual human being consists of many aspects.

Each human being is an aspect of the greater consciousness which is all one. These are mere words for you, but these words, with the progress envisaged for this year, will possibly open up an inner experience for many of you through which you will truly know that you are all one in consciousness. Perhaps you can gain an inkling of this even now when, after years of work, you are able to recognize and deal with a variety of aspects of your personality. Some of them are in disharmony with your conscious good will; some of them in unison. On the very deepest level there is a consciousness "aspect," if you will, that surpasses in beauty, wisdom, strength, and love even your best intentions, even your best capacities of bringing into unity your inner and, consequently, later also into your outer dissensions.

You are composed of all your aspects, and you learn to identify with each one of them, and identify them, one by one. Thus you gain an inkling of the sum total of your manifest being -- what you know of as "you." You learn to accept even those aspects that you do not like and thereby to transform their energy instead of separating yourself from these aspects so that they must manifest to you from the outside.

It is the same with creation as a whole. You are an aspect of the overall, total consciousness just as a specific aspect within you is an aspect of your total personality. Man's intrinsic fear to bridge the gap that exists between the little, separate ego consciousness and the All-Consciousness is due to the idea that if he bridges this gap, he will lose himself. Now this, of course, is totally the opposite of the truth. For the more you realize you are all, the more you will be you, the more complete you will be, the more whole you will be, and not the less.

It is really creation's aim to bridge this gap and establish the All-Consciousness. Again and again man asks himself, "Why does this gap exist?" Many explanations have been given about the so-called fall -- the fall from grace or the fall of the angels or whatever it may be called in religious terminology.

Let me at this time, as the first lecture of the year, give you a new version or a new approach to convey the same process. This is not just to give you information and teach you cosmology. Whatever I say about creation must be of immediate, practical value for your own development. Its purpose is not only to open you further to deepest cosmic truth outside of you. All these truths exist and can be found within you, right now if you wish. Eventually you will understand on the deepest level why you are this separated ego consciousness, why you are so afraid of letting yourself merge with the greater consciousness. You will know the illusion of this fear and the reality of the nature of suffering -- it being the result of your resistance and therefore unnecessary. And these words will help to open the door to this deeper knowledge and experience of eternal, immutable truth.

Once again I must repeat and remind you how difficult it is to put reality into the confines of human language. For human language, its terms and concepts, are fashioned according to a much narrower aspect of reality. Thus my words can always be misunderstood and therefore distorted or simply appear meaningless and not understandable if not confusing and contradictory. The three-dimensional terms can hardly contain verities of multi-dimensions that the human mind is incapable of grasping. Nevertheless, if you deliberately allow the understanding of the soul and heart, of the deepest intuition, to fill you, my words will reach you to some extent. There will be an echo of some inner understanding in you that again can hardly be put into words.

Creation started -- if it ever started, and of course it never started. So when I say started, it is again squeezing a concept into human language for which there is no other word. Try to feel this truth! Creation "started" with the divine spark. The spark may have been tiny in an immense vacuum. Yet in this tiny spark was the utmost of divine reality, comprising everything of consciousness, the most powerful creative energy, the most incredible wisdom and love. The infinite goodness of the divine Creator made it his aim or plan to gradually fill this vacuum, a vacuum of nothingness, the spark being the All. Gradually the spark began to spread and slowly interpenetrated the vacuum: the vacuum in its darkness and nothingness; the spark in its incredible light, its glowing aliveness and allness; the vacuum an infinity in the outer regions; the spark an infinity of the inner regions. Here a contradiction may appear in human dualistic terms. How could there be "two" infinities? It is quite impossible to convey this to the human consciousness. How it could be true that there is an infinity, but there is both vacuum and inner spark of eternal light, the latter filling the former?

The eternal spark, its inner infinite regions, spreads and spreads inexorably. Perhaps you can visualize a form, a picture: a thick golden, sparkling "liquid," teeming with energy and glorious creative potentials, all seeds contained in it, brilliant, effervescent, alive, intensely conscious, endowed with every conceivable and inconceivable power to create worlds, beings -- slowly spreading and spreading, aiming to fill the apparently infinite nothingness. Yet this is the All, in its infinity and eternity, filling this vacuum inexorably.

Since the All is such vibrant consciousness and powerful energy and aliveness, it must be the ultimate that cannot help but penetrate the entire vacuum until there is no longer a vacuum. The outer region will be entirely filled with the inner world of light and life.

In the process of spreading, particles of this All, of the divine spark, seem to get lost and "forget" the origin of their wholeness and their connectedness. These particles believe themselves

to be isolated dots of consciousness thrown into the outer darkness and struggling against being swallowed up by it. This struggle is an illusion. The fear is an illusion. The apparently isolated dot is not really isolated. The connection always exists, but in the process of penetration, the advancing, spreading life and allness is partially diminished in its manifestations. In this diminished state, there are "times" when the outer darkness seems nearer and more real than the inner life of the spark.

The outer vacuum is not evil, for evil is not nothing. Evil comes into existence when the divine spark loses its memory, has not yet regained its knowledge of connectedness, and struggles against the vacuum. The ferocious struggle against giving up being, existing, aliveness distorts divine reality and energy. The temporary transition creates a state that may be called evil. But it is temporary.

This temporarily and apparently separated aspect of divine reality must inevitably be drawn back into the ever spreading All. That is, it is not really "drawn back." It is rather that the ever growing fullness of the spreading spark "catches up with" the aspect that has moved ahead in a diminished form. All of nature with all her manifestations and various forms of life is part of this great and slowly advancing wave that fills the outer regions. Your own life manifestation, your struggle and your development are to be viewed in this light. Feel yourself as you bring truth and divinity into your whole being. This is the spark in you pushing to interpenetrate the outer regions. The more life on earth progresses in spirituality, justice, love, truth, and oneness, the more this creative process is being fulfilled.

Man's resistance to give up his negativity, his evil, is precisely due to what I say here. If the isolated aspect has lost sight and memory of its connectedness and its purpose in the whole scheme, it no longer can identify with the All-Consciousness of which it is a part. Thus by giving up the negative attitudes which are an expression of the struggle against the dark vacuum, the individual seems to be threatened with extinction. Giving up evil would then seem like voluntarily going into the dark nothingness, which is confused with physical death. Since the divine reality must ultimately fill everything that is, all particles must reunite themselves, or rather, detect that they have always been united with the All.

The fear of the vacuum engulfing the apparently separated divine spark is what you experience when you meet an innermost terror. For, as mentioned before, what I say here -- philosophical, metaphysical, and remote as it may sound -- is not a faraway happening that has nothing to do with your here and now, your present life. When you go deeply into yourself, you will find that this is an ongoing process that never stops and that takes place constantly in your inner and outer life. You will find the vacuum, the terror of it. And you will find ultimately the Eternal consciousness, the All-Consciousness, which is you and which can never die and which must slowly interpenetrate the vacuum.

The sooner you make room for these verities and are openly responsive to them, the sooner you will experience the true state of your being. But when your consciousness is steeped in the separateness as the only "reality," when it takes the momentary state as the last reality, your mind blocks off the experience.

This is the plan of creation, this is evolution, this is the aim. Can you see how you, every one of you, are a part of it? You have a task, for you are God. The ultimate in you, the all in you, sends

you forth, sends an aspect of Itself forth, which then manifests as an apparently separated ego consciousness. It is the task of this separated aspect to probe its own depths and potentialities to find the infinity of life, power, and wisdom, of love, beauty, and eternity. For all of the whole is also contained in the part. Thus it is your task indeed to make your whole conscious being aware of this so that you can consciously and deliberately spread your being into the vacuum. Fill the vacuum with your real nature.

When you deeply meditate, you will be able to use these concepts and truths for your immediate understanding of yourself and your life. All of you have gone deeply enough, or most of you have, so that you are ready to use these words to intuitively connect with them and know their truth. And when you know their truth, something very vital will change. For as you learn to accept the various aspects of yourself -- the positive and the negative ones -- and thus unify yourself, so will you feel in exactly the same way about your surroundings. And you will know that all people -- whether you like them or not, approve of them or not, whether they are developed beings or not -- are aspects of the whole just as you are an aspect of the whole. You will also know that what is negative, either in you or in others, is an aspect of the same that is positive. You will cease being alienated from and frightened by it. But you must first begin to cease being alienated from and frightened by whatever exists in you. For the more you fear aspects of yourself, the more this fear must be projected into outer life, onto other people and outer conditions. The only way you can cease being afraid of life, other people, of death is when you meet what you are most afraid of in yourself. This is the path. This is the path!

I have promised you, my friends, that in this coming year I will give more vital material and specific spiritual exercises that will help you further on your path. The first exercise I wish to give is a very important exercise dealing with the level of feeling. But before doing so, I want to give a short explanation in order to make the exercise understandable.

By now you have all been in touch with very deep feelings, feelings you have perhaps never before dared to accept, to experience. And you learned how to express them. But there is still a very important misconception in all of you about feelings, which is that you somehow have the idea that you can "get rid of" negative feelings. This is a slight distortion. Yet I do not wish to imply with my statement that you will always be burdened by unresolved negative feelings. We must make a clear distinction between stagnant, residual feelings the personality is unaware of holding back and the personality's innate capacity to experience any feeling if the state of the soul is fluid. For example, the less a person is afraid of his repressed anger and the more he learns to accept it, to express it, to assume responsibility for it rather than projecting it onto others, the freer such a person will be to produce anger "at will."

The moment you think of the process of this work in terms of "getting rid" of feelings, you must be in confusion. As I have said many times before, you transform the energy of an inappropriate, destructive feeling, you do not wipe it out. What I want to add here is that you make yourself conscious of the state (as yet only a possibility) in which you are so flexible, so moving, so much in command of yourself that all feelings can be produced because this potentiality always exists in you. The false ideal of a highly developed spiritual state is that it should be completely without anger, rage, fear, pain, sadness, or whatever. This idea is a distortion and leads to a rigid, unrealistic fixed image. The more you are capable of experiencing any feeling, the less you will be enslaved by it. The less you can summon feelings, the more you are really frightened of them and

therefore at their mercy. This may manifest in an uncontrolled, destructive acting out or in the stagnation of all creative energies, potentials, and feeling capacity. Like all falsehood, this misconception leads to a dualistic conflict, a double bind.

It is one of the essential by-products of aliveness, of the unitive state, to be in movement. The vacuum is fixed, the spark of the All is constant movement. Man is constantly battling between these two states. He is hankering for nonmovement, therefore he experiences the fear and terror of the vacuum. He wants nonmovement in the illusion that movement will carry him into the vacuum where his consciousness will cease. Yet the life spark within pushes toward movement.

Hence you, on your path, are learning to move your body; learning to move your feelings; learning to move your mind so that your spirit can move you. The moving spirit must be allowed to manifest. Therefore all other personality levels must align with spirit's innate nature -- movement.

You move your body in such a way that the energy flow can interpenetrate your entire physical system, your physical energy. You move your feelings by learning to let them out and feel their movement in you. You move your mind by spreading it to new ways of looking at something. This is a very essential task. Your fixed ideas prevent the spirit from moving your mind and being inspired by higher truth. I do not only refer to general concepts but much more to your immediate life situations and involvements. What happens is that you adopt certain opinions and judgments and then invest so much of your feeling energy into them that you eventually come to believe that these are actually your feelings. The negative energy is being created by fixed, unmoving, and therefore unavoidably untruthful thought and mind processes. The limited truth you believe to be the whole truth then becomes the tool of error and self-deception.

Thus what you may now believe to be emotions or feelings are often merely fixed opinions. And where your feeling capacity should unfold, you are paralyzed and unable to let the flow come and move you. The task of any pathwork is to bring the whole system into movement. But it requires a very finely attuned timing to know when that is appropriate; otherwise, harm can be done. Every level of the personality requires a different approach. Also, before certain exercises are being used, there must exist some agility in body, feeling, and mind; otherwise distortions will occur. For example, the deliberately produced feelings may be distorted into a dramatization, exaggeration, fake feelings. The self-will may be used to put up a good show and foster the illusion that the soul is flexible and in a state of flux.

By the same token, when the mind exercises itself by trying out new alternatives of seeing a situation with the ulterior motive to get away from facing blame, accusation, and self-justifying victimization; this may lead to a false, superimposed serenity that covers up a great deal of negative feelings that have not yet been dealt with. So you can see that timing plays a great role here.

Let us now consider what I said about negative feelings -- namely, that it is a distortion to aim at getting completely rid of them. As long as you cultivate your capacity to produce and experience any feeling, then this feeling, even if undesirable, will have no power over you. Nothing ever gets fixedly and definitively "behind" you. There is no future state where it is all accomplished and you no longer need to move. This concept arises in itself out of fear of movement, rejection of movement, hence out of the illusion that movement is undesirable. If you are in a state of truth, movement is desirable, while non-movement is to be avoided.

Let us take the physical level as an example. Suppose you have sufficiently worked on the body and emotional levels so as to remove all your muscular blocks. This does not mean that now you can cease moving your body. Were you to do so, new blocks and stagnancies would soon form all over again. For your decision to remain nonmoving would be based on a false concept of life; hence negative feelings (in this case, fear) would develop. If you don't deal with this fear by recognizing and accepting it and by challenging, then you give in to the false idea, the fear, which then prevents you from movement on all levels.

The healthy individual continues to move -- now no longer for therapeutic reasons, but out of joyousness. The movement is then no longer a chore, it is a pleasure. As long as it is a chore, the temptation to go into stagnancy and give in to the vacuum principle is great. This must be overcome by moving your mind into new directions, by deciding to move all levels so that your spirit can interpenetrate and enliven all levels with its life and its truth. Your spirit wants to bring light into the darkness and movement into the stagnancy. If you stop moving, you begin to die.

On the feeling level, the same holds true. A person who is advanced in his development may indeed have resolved residual feelings of hate. He may have gone through his residual pain. He may have dissipated his residual anger. Not only does this not mean that such a person cannot and will not experience these feelings ever again. Just the contrary -- the more residual feelings have been dealt with, accepted, and are no longer feared and rejected, the greater the ability to move the soul currents at any time in any direction. He can now make available to himself any time the experience of any feeling whatever -- at will. This must not be tight self-will. It must be the smooth, healthy inner will. If you can do this, if you can at will produce violent hate and anger; at will produce pain and sadness; at will produce fear and terror; at will produce equanimity and peace; pleasure and joy; love and compassion; then you are indeed in possession of yourself and can be moved from within.

Those who have a tendency to overdramatize, to be willful, and to counterfeit feelings should abstain from these exercises because they must first shed the mask that hides their shame of their real feelings. Those who have a tendency to use certain limited emotions as a defense against other emotions should deliberately abstain for a while from using the superimposed feeling to practice with. Say someone uses fear as a defense against spite, violence, malice, hate. All those feelings must be worked out before any exercises should be attempted.

It will not be difficult for you to see that the person who is very contracted, restricted, and alienated from his core is unable to produce any feelings -- or only a very limited amount. He is numb and paralyzed on that level. While the person who is already much more liberated from the constriction and defenses just because the residual feelings have been dealt with is much more flexible and can easily decide to be angry, to be sad, or to be in whatever emotional state he wishes to be at the moment.

Gradually, exercises should be done with this in mind, and all of you should evaluate where each individual is in this respect. This will prove immensely helpful and further your development. Use your inner guidance as to when and how to apply them. The knowledge of these principles is very important. When you can increasingly produce feelings, you will not only be more able to bring out any last vestiges and remnants of residual feelings that have been neglected, but even when they are completely gone, your emotional fluidity should be practiced so that your soul substance remains

vibrant and flowing. I have always mentioned how important soul movements are. The inner cosmic movements that constantly go through you can only be made conscious when your emotional state is agile, and you can easily emote. Let yourself be inspired about these exercises. Do them deliberately. Of course it does require the energy of more people. It is much more difficult to do these exercises alone, although eventually you will even be able to do that.

Begin by listening into yourself what the predominant feeling at this moment is. First it may only be faint, and you need to build it up and allow yourself full, intense experience of it and expression of it. After that, you can go into other feelings as they may wish to manifest from within. Other times your helper may decide to concentrate on certain feelings. Or your inspired mind will direct you. Always work with meditation, asking for guidance and inspiration.

This practice of making yourself fluid and flexible is very important for your ultimate alignment with your divine center. As I mentioned, there are also mind exercises that will be given. In the meantime, I will give you a specific one. Take any situation you are in now that is of bother to you, that is disturbance in your life, and look at the construction you have built in your mind. How you have built a certain form with your mind by your conclusion which you fix forever tighter so as to convince yourself and eliminate your disturbing self doubts. Probe with your active, deciding faculty to envisage other alternatives from the one you chose. Play with these other alternatives. Again allow your spirit to inspire and guide your mind into new channels, channels in which you are neither annihilated (as you think would happen if you should abandon your fixed view), nor are you holding on to the present interpretation. The latter is to a considerable extent responsible for the very disturbance that you suffer. See this.

Often you must first unearth what it is you really believe. But once this has happened, those beliefs must be flexible; other beliefs considered; the mind outlook widened about the very topic you most fixedly protect with certain opinions. You wish to believe that your judgments, thoughts, and opinions are a result of a specific disturbing situation. I say that it is the other way around. The disturbing situation is a result of your tendency to harbor just such thoughts, judgments, and opinions because of an underlying motivation and intentionality. Perhaps these can be faced with less resistance when you make your mind more flexible to try out new alternatives as interpretations. If this tendency to build a cluster of opinions and judgments under certain circumstances exists, it is always there in abeyance, waiting for the next occasion. In other words, the psychological deviations are connected with a fixed, inflexible mind, a rigidity on the level of thought that must be dealt with in active, focused exercises. The more you are willing to do this and request inner guidance and inspiration that your mind can make the steps beyond the confines of the construct, the more flexible your mind is going to become.

As the years go by, you will learn to do this better and better. Bring your whole being -- your physical being, your emotional being, and your mental being -- into alignment with the divine center through the ability to be fluid and flexible on all levels. That should be the motto for the work you begin this season.

Before closing the lecture, I want to give another exercise in the form of meditation on the triad of pride, self-will, and fear. See the same bothersome situation from the viewpoint of pride. In what respect are you in pride? Then visualize this same situation focusing on how it would feel to give up this pride. If the only alternative seems being humiliated, then start probing for other

possibilities. Ask for inner guidance and experience yourself without pride, yet also in dignity and without humiliation. You have to make a real inner, volitional step to be able to see yourself in a new way that conciliates dignity and humility and leaves out both pride and humiliating submission. If you are ready for this possibility, even before you can experience it, the divine life will produce it from within. But you must make yourself receptive to it.

Then do the same with self-will. Envisage yourself in a new state of reaction in which you are neither self-willed nor spineless and exploited, in which you assert yourself and can let go and give in. The proper balance will come from your core in specific ways for specific situations. But the mind must be open and flexible enough to let in new possibilities and the spiritual capacities in you cultivated so that you entrust yourself to the inner guidance.

Have the courage to go through the anxiety that will be the first result when attempting to give up pride and self-will. Then, last but not least, you come to the fear. The fear cannot possibly vanish before pride and self-will are being abandoned. For fear is a product of both, as you know, at least in theory. Also see the fear in terms of distrust of the universe. You evidently believe that only your self-will and pride can protect you from danger. This implies that the universe is untrustworthy and all you have as a safeguard is this puny protection: your pride and self-will. Question this premise and experiment with new alternatives in this respect. Open yourself for the divine reality to flood through you. Maybe now, maybe later, but come it must and penetrate you with a state of consciousness in which there is no self-will, pride, and fear, and where therefore the conflicts outside and inside are transcended.

Do an exercise in trust in which you open yourself for the possibility that the universe will yield you whatever you need. Experiment for the moment with this thought: "How would it be if I were to trust the universe, if in this particular situation I gave up the fear that is a result of my distrust and therefore of pride and self-will?" Allow your central core to fill you with an inkling of a state in which you can react without self-will, pride, and fear.

These are preliminary exercises, my friends, to practice for your further development.

Love and blessings are being given to everyone here, with a tremendous force that you can utilize. Let it open your inner being so that it can then flow out of you into your outer being. The universe is good and beautiful, and there is nothing to fear, neither inside nor outside, no matter how much it may appear otherwise due to your present distortions. Let love into you so that it can come out of you. Be blessed, be in peace.

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